

Amazon lowers prices for S3

Amazon S3, or Amazon Simple Storage Service, is a cloud storage service. Unlike Dropbox or other cloud backup and sync services Amazon S3 isn't meant for consumers, it's for use as a storage and distribution service. It provides an API for storing, retrieving, setting permissions for and deleting objects on their service, and is intended to be used at the back-end of sites. Amazon levies charges for S3 based on how much storage is used, how much bandwidth is consumed and the number of requests made to their API on a monthly basis. The current price drop is for storage consumption only and not for bandwidth usage or API requests.

To see the full list of price changes, go to <http://bit.ly/yc6aSo>. 

Welcome to the jungle, says Amazon

While most of us were expecting Amazon.com to launch its India site, it came as a slight surprise when it launched Junglee.com instead. With a name that is at once a nod to its parent company and the South American rainforest, Junglee.com also subtly separates itself in form and function from Amazon. It officially refers to the Hindi word meaning "of the jungle", and is a site that helps

retailers in India, and would have been called an aggregator if it didn't also sell stuff from Amazon.com. The site currently boasts of a wide product range, spanning 12 million products and 14,000 brands, with a plethora of retailers lined up including online stores and deal-of-the-day sites such as Saholic.com and Snapdeal.com, and others such as Homeshop18, UniverCell, Hidesign, Gitanjali, The Bombay Store, Fabindia, Bata India Limited, Dabur

Here's the downside though. You still pay the full shipping costs if you make international purchases from Amazon, so there's no benefit to customers. You're better off buying your gadgets from Ebay India.

Junglee.com also features customer reviews, product and seller ratings and integration with Facebook, Twitter, other social networking sites and email if you want to share your finds with friends. Amazon.com's reviews are also available.

The good thing about shopping on Junglee is that you discover sites and stores that you've never heard of, and you have so many more product variations to choose from, including those available exclusively abroad.

Junglee.com is currently in beta mode, and expects to continuously evolve based on user feedback.

For now, amazon.co.in doesn't seem likely given how the Indian government has yet to give its final go-ahead for FDI in multi-brand retail. 



customers "navigate the jungle of products, brands, sellers, shipping options and payment methods, and make informed purchase decisions."

Junglee.com is called an "online shopping service" where customers can search for products from online and offline

Uveda, Microsoft India Store and Reebok.

Rather than buying directly, users of Junglee.com are directed to the seller's web site, and in cases of physical stores, given directions and contact details to place an order. There's a selection of buying options.

Flipkart acquires Letsbuy

Flipkart has acquired LetsBuy for an undisclosed sum. Reports estimate that it was bought for roughly \$20-25 million. LetsBuy's founders and 350 employees will stay on, as will the online retail site. Flipkart, which until now has been looking to sell across categories, will now be able to use Letsbuy's

richer catalogue of electronics and lifestyle products.

LetsBuy is the second-largest online electronic goods retailer and one of Flipkart's biggest competitors.

Speaking about the deal, Flipkart's CEO and co-founder, Sachin Bansal, said: "This acquisition fits into our strategy of building dominant shares in all



categories where we operate. We are already leaders in the books and media verticals. Given that we managed to build a leadership position in consumer elec-

tronics as well since its launch in early 2011, it made sense for us to consolidate when we saw this opportunity. This acquisition opportunity came at a very attractive price and the timing had also been ideal. The synergies will now allow us to accelerate faster and get to a share similar to what we enjoy in the online books category." 